Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Testing for Diagnosis of Active or Latent Tuberculosis

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- An interferon gamma release assay (IGRA) (CPT code 86480, CPT code 86481) and an acid fast bacilli (AFB) smear or stain (CPT code 87116) **ARE REIMBURSABLE** to diagnose latent tuberculosis (TB) infection for individuals at risk for infection based on clinical presentation or risk factors noted below upon screening evaluation:
    - Abnormal weight loss
    - Acute kidney failure or chronic renal disease
    - Cough
    - Crohn's disease
    - Diabetes mellitus
    - Enlarged lymph nodes
    - Human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) disease
    - Immunodeficiency
    - Lymphoma, leukemia or multiple myeloma
    - Malignant neoplasm of head, face and neck
    - Nonspecific reaction to cell mediated immunity measurement of gamma interferon antigen response
    - Nonspecific reaction to tuberculin skin test without active tuberculosis
    - Opioid or illicit substance use
    - Pericardial effusion
    - Pleural effusion
    - Pulmonary nodule
    - Rheumatoid arthritis
    - Steroid or immunosuppressant use
    - Transplanted organ and tissue status when screening is mandated
- For individuals diagnosed with TB, nucleic acid testing for *Mycobacterium* (CPT code 87551, CPT code 87556, CPT code 87561) **IS REIMBURSABLE.**

- For individuals with active tuberculosis, IGRA (CPT code 86480, CPT code 86481) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.
- Quantitative nucleic acid testing for *Mycobacterium* species (CPT code 87552), *M. tuberculosis* (CPT code 87557) and *M. avium complex* (CPT code 87562) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.
- Genotyping of *Mycobacterium* species (CPT code 87150, CPT code 87153) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.
- Adenosine deaminase (ADA) (CPT code 84311) levels in cerebrospinal, pleural, peritoneal, pericardial and other fluids for the diagnosis of extrapulmonary TB **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.
- Tests designed to detect or diagnose TB through detection of serum biomarkers (CPT code 0574U) **ARE NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure code	Code description
84311	Spectrophotometry, analyte not elsewhere specified
86480	Tuberculosis test, cell mediated immunity antigen response measurement; gamma interferon
86481	Tuberculosis test, cell mediated immunity antigen response measurement; enumeration of gamma interferon-producing T-cells in cell suspension
87116	Culture, tubercle or other acid-fast bacilli (eg, TB, AFB, mycobacteria) any source, with isolation and presumptive identification of isolates
87150	Culture, typing; identification by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA) probe, amplified probe technique, per culture or isolate, each organism probed
87153	Culture, typing; identification by nucleic acid sequencing method, each isolate (eg, sequencing of the 16S rRNA gene)
87551	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycobacteria species, amplified probe technique
87552	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycobacteria species, quantification
87556	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycobacteria tuberculosis, amplified probe technique
87557	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycobacteria tuberculosis, quantification
87561	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycobacteria avium-intracellulare, amplified probe technique
87562	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycobacteria avium-intracellulare, quantification
0574U	Mycobacterium tuberculosis, culture filtrate protein–10-kDa (CFP-10), serum or plasma, liquid chromatography mass spectrometry (LC-MS) Proprietary Test: NanoDetect-TB™ Lab/Manufacturer: NanoPin Technologies, Inc

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